

Microsoft Research →

AutoGen

↳ open source framework

↳ Powered - LLMs

↳ Agent - Co-ordinating

↓  
(Conversation each other)

Society Agents

↳ Role, SM, Set of tools

↳ [Exchange messages] → Task Solved

AutoGen →

AutoGen

Agents → Talking Agent

Exchange Messages

planning, delegation, critique  
code generation,  
code execution,  
correction

## Core Components of AutoGen

### The Layered Architecture

① autogen - core → runtime

② autogen - agent chat → High level, Batteries included  
API → Built core

Developer use

- Assistant agent, User proxy agent,  
Code Executor agent

- Teams

↳ Round Robin Chat,  
Selector group chat,  
Swarm,  
Magnetic One group chat

- Termination  
Conditions

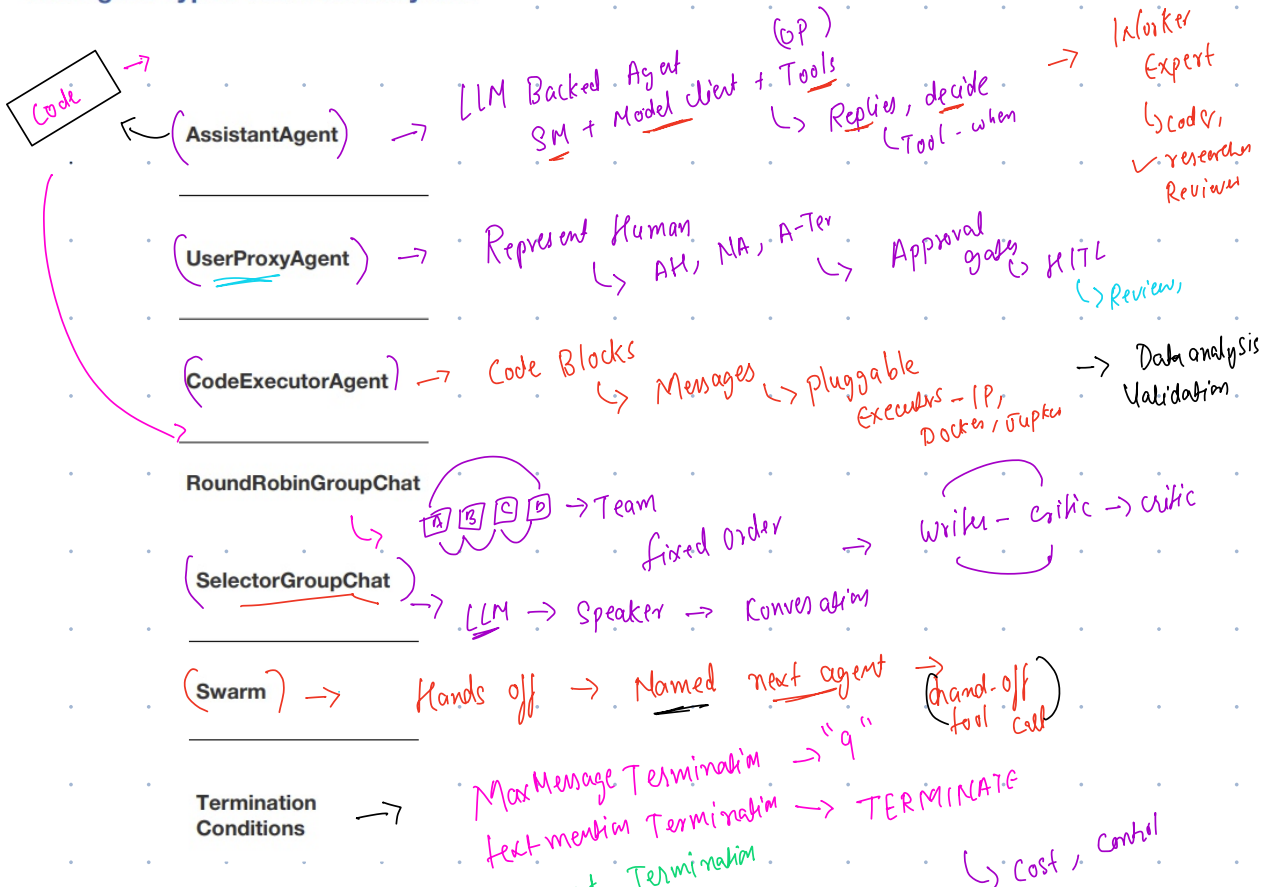
↳ composable  
stop rule for  
conversation

→ Autogen-ext → pluggable extensions,

model clients → Open AI, Azure, Anthropic  
code executors → Tool adapters → MCP, Memory, Telemetry

→ Autogen Studio → drag-drop UI over Agent chat  
↳ Noncode workflow

## The Agent Types You'll Actually Use



Timeout  
AND/OR

Tools and Memory

↳ Tools → langchain Tool adapters,  
MCP - autogen-ext  
Memory → Simple list Based memory, Vector Store Backed  
Model Clients → openAI, Anthropic, local-ollama  
Agentic - logic - some  
Swap

Approach - Building Agents

Crew AI → Crew with Roles and process  
langgraph → State machine / Graph  
Autogen → group of Agents → asynchronous messages  
Workflow emerges  
Done

When to AutoGen

- ① open Ended - Exploratory Task
- ② coding and data analysis
- ③ Heavy Human In the loop + IITL
- ④ Multi perspective / adversarial patterns  
(planner - exc - ver)  
(debate A-A)

Bad fit

→ strict, auditable

- ① Confusion - Versions
- ② Token Cast - Saad with Turns  
↳ Max Message Termination
- ③ SandBox Code - Feature
- ④ - Auditable, Round Robin Group Chat.

| Dimension              | AutoGen                                                   | LangGraph                                                      | CrewAI                                                        | Agno                                                         |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core abstraction       | Conversing agents / actor-model messaging                 | Explicit graph (nodes + edges) = state machine                 | Roles + Process (sequential/hierarchical) + Flows             | Lightweight Agent objects + Teams; minimal abstraction layer |
| Orchestration style    | Emergent from conversation, or explicit hand-off (Swarm)  | Fully explicit, developer-defined graph, incl. cycles/branches | Declarative: define roles & tasks, process drives order       | Direct, imperative — you call agents/teams like functions    |
| Control over flow      | Medium (dynamic selection can be non-deterministic)       | High — deterministic, inspectable, resumable                   | Medium — process types are somewhat fixed patterns            | High — thin layer, you control the loop                      |
| State management       | Conversation history is the state                         | First-class typed state object, checkpointing built in         | Task outputs passed along the process                         | Session/User state, storage & memory built in                |
| Human-in-the-loop      | Native (UserProxyAgent modes)                             | Native (interrupt/resume on the graph)                         | Supported, less central to the model                          | Supported via hooks                                          |
| Code execution         | Native, first-class (CodeExecutorAgent, Docker sandbox)   | Possible via tools/nodes, not a core primitive                 | Possible via tools, not a core primitive                      | Possible via tools, not a core primitive                     |
| Performance / overhead | Moderate — async runtime adds some overhead               | Moderate — graph engine overhead, optimized for correctness    | Moderate                                                      | Very low — built for speed, small memory footprint           |
| Learning curve         | Medium-High (event-driven concepts, version split)        | High (graph & state-machine thinking)                          | Low (most approachable)                                       | Low-Medium (simple API, more concepts at scale)              |
| Best known for         | Research-grade multi-agent conversation & code-gen agents | Production-grade, controllable, auditable agent pipelines      | Fast standup of role-based agent teams for business workflows | Raw speed, model-agnostic, production-serving many agents    |
| Backing / ecosystem    | Microsoft Research                                        | LangChain team / ecosystem                                     | Independent OSS, large community                              | Independent OSS (formerly Phidata)                           |

- **AutoGen:** "Let the agents talk it out."

- **LangGraph:** "Draw the state machine, then run it."

- **CrewAI:** "Assign roles to a crew and define the process."

- **Agno:** "Keep it thin and fast — just agents and teams, minimal ceremony."

— Debate, Critique, Collaborate, Code, fined-tune, Novel - In

→ Branching, Durable, Audib, state, Stand up team, na- sess, Hies,

↳ Raw performance, low messes, simplicity, Thin model agnostic layer, native multi modality But in storage / Gize